JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with seven years of hands-on experience building scalable systems and mentoring engineering teams. I've worked across fintech and cloud infrastructure, taking ownership of critical backend services that handle millions of daily transactions. I'm pragmatic about technical decisions, preferring solutions that work reliably over unnecessary complexity. Outside of architecture and system design, I genuinely enjoy helping junior engineers grow their skills.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

TechVault Solutions

www.techvault.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led the redesign of our payment processing pipeline, reducing latency by 45% and improving throughput from 5,000 to 12,000 transactions per second. Established engineering standards and code review practices across the backend team of eight engineers, resulting in a 60% reduction in production incidents. Designed and implemented a distributed caching layer using Redis and Memcached that cut database load by 35% during peak hours. Mentored four junior engineers through their progression toward mid-level roles, conducting weekly technical reviews and growth planning sessions.

Senior Backend Engineer

DataFlow Systems

www.dataflow.co

Manchester, United Kingdom

July 2019 - February 2022

Architected a real-time data ingestion platform capable of processing 50 million events daily, built with Kafka, PostgreSQL, and Go microservices. Reduced API response times from 800ms to 120ms by implementing query optimization and introducing connection pooling across twelve production services. Owned the migration of legacy monolithic services to containerized microservices, coordinating with DevOps to ensure zero-downtime deployments across Kubernetes clusters. Led incident response for critical production issues, establishing postmortems and implementing preventative measures that reduced mean time to resolution by 40%.

Software Engineer

CloudFirst Ltd

www.cloudfirst.net

Manchester, United Kingdom

August 2017 - June 2019

Built RESTful APIs and backend services using Python and Java, serving requests from mobile and web applications with millions of monthly active users. Implemented database optimization strategies including proper indexing and query refactoring, improving slow report generation times from 15 minutes to under 3 minutes. Participated in on-call rotation and resolved production incidents with an average resolution time of 25 minutes

across the team. Contributed to infrastructure automation using Terraform and Ansible, reducing time to provision new environments from hours to minutes.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

2013 - 2017

SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL, JavaScript

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda), Google Cloud Platform

Backend Frameworks: Spring Boot, Django, FastAPI

DevOps Tools: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Jenkins

Messaging Systems: Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Monitoring and Observability: Datadog, Prometheus, ELK Stack

Version Control: Git, GitHub

Methodologies: Agile, Microservices Architecture, System Design